

GitHub 2.0: The Handoff

3 Review, Merge, and Sync Back

~12 min

1 Open PR

Go to YOUR repo on GitHub.com. You have a PR from your partner waiting.

2 Review

Click 'Files changed.' Green = added. Red = removed.

3 Comment

Click a line number to comment on a specific line. Even 'Looks good!' counts.

4 Merge

'Merge pull request' → Confirm → 'Delete branch.' Clean house.

5 Sync

In Replit: Git pane → Pull. Your partner's change appears in your project.

✓ Loop complete. Code round-tripped: Builder → GitHub → Partner → Branch → PR → Main → Builder. Nothing broke.

The Handoff Protocol

Your build-cycle working agreement — keep this

1

Main should always work. No direct commits to main. Ever.

2

Branch first, then edit. Check the branch indicator before you type.

3

One branch = one person = one task. Descriptive names: feature/..., fix/...

4

Every AI generation gets a prompt doc in /prompts, committed with the code (or link to chat).

5

Commits say who/how. Hand-edited vs. AI-generated, and which prompt doc.

6

All changes enter main through a PR. At least one teammate reviews before merging.

7

Pull before you start; push before you stop.

8

The builder tool is personal; the repo is shared. GitHub is where the team meets.

When Things Go Wrong

"I can't push"

Click Pull first (someone else pushed before you). Then try pushing again.

Editing on main by accident

GitHub Desktop: Branch menu → New Branch. Your uncommitted changes move to the new branch automatically.

Can't find the text in code

Ctrl/Cmd+Shift+F (project-wide search). If still stuck, check src/pages/ or src/components/ first.

Collaborator invite not arriving

Check your email spam folder. Or go directly to github.com/notifications.

Replit sync looks stale

Open Git pane → Pull. If still stale, make a small commit on GitHub.com to nudge the sync.

Out of Replit credits

Ask a mentor for a backup repo. You can skip to Round 2 — nobody sits out.

Essential Shortcuts

Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + F Search all files (VS Code)

Ctrl/Cmd + S Save current file

Ctrl/Cmd + Z Undo last edit

. on any GitHub repo Open github.dev editor (Plan B!)

Plan B: github.dev

If your local tools break, press . (period) on any GitHub repo page. A full VS Code editor opens in your browser — edit, commit, and push with zero installs. Works on any computer with a browser.

Before Your First Build-Cycle Session

- 1 One teammate creates the team repo and invites everyone as collaborators.
- 2 Everyone clones and does a test handoff — one commit on a branch with a PR. Surface setup issues early.
- 3 Write your scaffold prompt together. Commit it to /prompts before anyone builds.
- 4 Read the Handoff Protocol as a team. Out loud. These are your house rules.